

Bukavu Kivu Swahili: 50-item variation pilot

Target: Natural child-directed tutor scaffolding used in Bukavu

This is an elicitation and validation packet, not a test of the speaker. Write what a real teacher, parent, or tutor from your community would naturally say to one child.

Speaker and reviewer information

Name or participant code	
Home town / community	
Named language variety	
Other languages regularly used	
Role (teacher / parent / other)	
Age group taught or cared for	
Reviewer name or code	
Date	

Instructions

1. Read the situation and Standard Kiswahili reference; preserve the same teaching purpose.
 2. Write the exact wording you would naturally use with one child in Bukavu. Do not imitate Tanzanian or Kenyan speech unless that is genuinely how you speak.
 3. Keep every example word, name, letter, sound, and number unchanged.
 4. Use ordinary normalized Swahili spelling. Note a spoken pronunciation separately instead of inventing a spelling.
 5. Add French or English only where it is natural in this context; do not force a switch.
 6. Stay within the stated maximum words where possible. Add alternatives or uncertainty in Notes.
- Consent note: do not include a child's real name, phone number, address, school, or other identifying information. Participation should be voluntary, and project consent procedures must be followed before collecting recordings.

01. instr-start-beginner-001 | Category: instruction | Level: beginner | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Ask the child to look at the letter shown and say its sound.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Tazama herufi hii. Sasa, say the sound unayoiona!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

02. instr-start-letter-syllable-001 | Category: instruction | Level: letter_syllable | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Ask the child to read the syllable shown aloud.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hebu sasa soma syllable hii kwa sauti.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

03. instr-start-word-001 | Category: instruction | Level: word | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Ask the child to read the word shown aloud.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Sawa, hebu usome neno hili kwa sauti!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

04. instr-start-paragraph-001 | Category: instruction | Level: paragraph | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Ask the child to read the paragraph aloud, at their own pace.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Sawa, sasa soma kifungu hiki kwa sauti, pole pole.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

05. instr-start-story-001 | Category: instruction | Level: story | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Ask the child to read the story aloud from the beginning.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Sawa! Sasa read hadithi hii kwa sauti kuanzia mwanzo.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

06. instr-comprehension-001 | Category: instruction | Level: story | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Ask a simple comprehension question about the story just read.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Great! Sasa niambie, hadithi hii ilikuwa inamhusu nani?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

07. instr-retry-001 | Category: instruction | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Ask the child to try reading the same item one more time.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hebu jaribu kuisoma tena. One more time!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

08. instr-slow-down-001 | Category: instruction | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Ask the child to slow down and read at a calmer pace.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Soma polepole, take your time, usiache maneno.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

09. praise-first-try-beginner-001 | Category: praise | Level: beginner | Audience: child | Maximum: 8 words

Situation: Praise correct letter-sound on the first try.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hongera! Good job, umeitamka vizuri!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

10. praise-first-try-syllable-001 | Category: praise | Level: letter_syllable | Audience: child | Maximum: 8 words

Situation: Praise correct syllable read on the first try.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Vizuri! First try, umeisoma sawasawa!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

11. praise-first-try-word-001 | Category: praise | Level: word | Audience: child | Maximum: 8 words

Situation: Praise correct word read on the first try.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hongera! First try, umelisoma neno vizuri!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

12. praise-first-try-paragraph-001 | Category: praise | Level: paragraph | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Praise fluent reading of a full paragraph.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Umesoma kifungu vizuri sana. Great job!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

13. praise-first-try-story-001 | Category: praise | Level: story | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Praise finishing a story with strong fluency.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Umeisoma hadithi yote kwa ufasaha. Well done!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

14. praise-after-retry-word-001 | Category: praise | Level: word | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Praise the child for succeeding after a retry.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Umeweza! Good job kwa kujaribu tena!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

15. praise-after-retry-syllable-001 | Category: praise | Level: letter_syllable | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Praise the child for succeeding after a retry at syllable level.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Umeisoma vizuri baada ya kujaribu tena. Well done!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

16. praise-comprehension-001 | Category: praise | Level: story | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Praise a thoughtful answer to a comprehension question.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Vizuri sana! Jibu lako ni zuri, umefikiria vizuri!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

17. hint-letter-sound-001 | Category: hint | Level: beginner | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Prompt the child to think of the sound the letter makes.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hebu fikiria: herufi hii ina sauti gani?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

18. hint-syllable-blend-001 | Category: hint | Level: letter_syllable | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Prompt the child to blend the two sounds in the syllable together.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hebu unganisha sauti hizo mbili, then say them together.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

19. hint-word-first-letter-001 | Category: hint | Level: word | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Prompt the child to look at the first letter of the word.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Angalia herufi ya kwanza. Inasema nini?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

20. hint-word-familiar-001 | Category: hint | Level: word | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Suggest the word looks like one they already know.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Neno hili linafanana na unalolijua. Try kukumbuka.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

21. hint-sentence-context-001 | Category: hint | Level: paragraph | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Suggest using the rest of the sentence as a clue for the tricky word.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Soma sentensi yote; maneno mengine yatakupa clue.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

22. hint-story-context-001 | Category: hint | Level: story | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Suggest thinking about what would make sense in the story so far.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Fikiria story yetu. Neno gani linafaa hapa?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

23. hint-comprehension-001 | Category: hint | Level: story | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Suggest thinking back to what happened earlier in the story.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Fikiria kidogo — nini kilitokea mwanzo wa hadithi?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

24. correction-letter-soft-001 | Category: correction | Level: beginner | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Gently correct a misread letter sound without saying "wrong".

Standard Kiswahili reference: Ulikaribia! Sikiliza sauti ya herufi hii: mmm. Try again.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

25. correction-syllable-soft-001 | Category: correction | Level: letter_syllable | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Gently correct a misread syllable.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Karibu! Hebu tusikie tena — sema "si", si "su".

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

26. correction-word-soft-001 | Category: correction | Level: word | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Gently correct a misread word.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Karibu! Hebu tujaribu tena, soma neno hili polepole.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

27. correction-sentence-soft-001 | Category: correction | Level: paragraph | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Gently correct a misread sentence within a paragraph.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Karibu! Hebu jaribu tena, soma sentensi polepole zaidi.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

28. correction-model-pronunciation-001 | Category: correction | Level: word | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Model the correct pronunciation and ask the child to repeat it.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Sikiliza: 'shule.' Sasa repeat after me: 'shule.'

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

29. correction-comprehension-001 | Category: correction | Level: story | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Gently correct a misunderstanding without discouraging the child.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hmm, hebu tusikie tena — jibu liko karibu sana!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

30. level-up-beginner-to-letter-001 | Category: level_transition | Level: beginner | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Announce moving up from beginner to letter/syllable level.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hongera! Sasa tunaendelea na silabi. Are you ready?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

31. level-up-letter-to-word-001 | Category: level_transition | Level: letter_syllable | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Announce moving up from letter/syllable to word level.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hongera! Sasa tunaendelea kusoma maneno. Ready? Twende!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

32. level-up-word-to-paragraph-001 | Category: level_transition | Level: word | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Announce moving up from word to paragraph level.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hongera! Sasa tutasoma kifungu kizima. Ready?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

33. level-up-paragraph-to-story-001 | Category: level_transition | Level: paragraph | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Announce moving up from paragraph to story level.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hongera! Sasa tutasoma hadithi nzima. Ready? Twende!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

34. level-stay-beginner-001 | Category: level_transition | Level: beginner | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Reassure the child they're staying at beginner level to build confidence.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Tutaendelea kufanya mazoezi ya sauti za herufi. You're doing well!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

35. level-stay-letter-001 | Category: level_transition | Level: letter_syllable | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Reassure the child they're staying at letter/syllable level.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Tutaendelea kufanya mazoezi ya silabi. You're doing well!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

36. encourage-tired-001 | Category: encouragement | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Encourage a child who seems to be losing focus or getting tired.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Umefanya vizuri sana! Keep going, tunakaribia mwisho!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

37. encourage-frustrated-001 | Category: encouragement | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Reassure a child who seems frustrated after a few misses in a row.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Usijali, baadhi ya maneno ni magumu. Keep trying, unaweza!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

38. encourage-nervous-001 | Category: encouragement | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Reassure a shy or nervous-sounding child before they begin.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Usiwe na wasiwasi; tuko pamoja. Ready? Tuanze!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

39. encourage-halfway-001 | Category: encouragement | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Encourage the child partway through, noting they're doing this well.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Umefika mbali! Keep it up, unaendelea vizuri!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

40. encourage-hard-item-001 | Category: encouragement | Level: paragraph | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Encourage the child before a noticeably harder item.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hili ni gumu kidogo, lakini unaweza. Ready?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

41. closing-session-complete-001 | Category: closing | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Close out a normal session and tell the child what happens next.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Hongera sana! Umefanya vizuri leo. Tutaendelea kesho, sawa?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

42. closing-session-paused-001 | Category: closing | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Tell the child the session is being paused and can continue later.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Tutapumzika hapa. Tutaendelea baadaye, okay?

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

43. closing-session-ended-early-001 | Category: closing | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 14 words

Situation: Warmly end a session that's stopping earlier than planned.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Umejifahidi leo! Tutaishia hapa na kuendelea wakati mwingine. Bye!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

44. repair-no-audio-001 | Category: repair | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 8 words

Situation: Nothing was heard. Ask the child to try again.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Samahani, sikusikia. Please jaribu tena.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

45. repair-too-quiet-001 | Category: repair | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 8 words

Situation: Audio was too quiet. Ask the child to speak a little louder.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Sema tena, sauti kubwa zaidi kidogo!

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

46. repair-background-noise-001 | Category: repair | Level: any | Audience: child | Maximum: 10 words

Situation: Too much background noise. Ask the child to move somewhere quieter or closer to the phone.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Kuna noise nyingi. Tafadhali sokea karibu na simu.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

47. escalate-call-facilitator-001 | Category: escalation | Level: any | Audience: facilitator | Maximum: 8 words

Situation: Alert the facilitator that repeated repair attempts have failed and their attention is needed now.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Tafadhali saidia; repair attempts tatu zimeshindwa.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

48. escalate-technical-fault-001 | Category: escalation | Level: any | Audience: facilitator | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Report a technical fault to the facilitator in plain, factual terms.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Kuna hitilafu ya kiufundi. Session haiwezi kuendelea sasa.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

49. facilitator-confirm-level-001 | Category: facilitator | Level: any | Audience: facilitator | Maximum: 12 words

Situation: Ask the facilitator to confirm the assigned reading level before it takes effect.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Tafadhali confirm kiwango cha kusoma kabla hakijahifadhiwa.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	

50. facilitator-session-summary-001 | Category: facilitator | Level: any | Audience: facilitator | Maximum: 16 words

Situation: Report a brief factual summary of the session's results to the facilitator.

Standard Kiswahili reference: Session imekamilika: maneno 18 sahihi, makosa 4 kwenye sauti za herufi.

Natural Bukavu Kivu Swahili	
French/English switch, if natural	
Notes / alternative wording	